Pierre-Luc Wagner

Infrastructure & Platform Engineer

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PROFILE

Infrastructure engineer, ten years on the platform behind La Presse, one of Canada's largest newsrooms. I spent most of that decade on the reliability side: on-call, incident and cost reduction, observability, and cutting the repetitive work that wakes people up at night. I manage the team today, but I am at my best in the technical work: a hands-on SRE role is what I want.

IMPACT

2 → 0
Kubernetes incidents a week, after EKS and the CNI swap

1,200 VMs
on-premise fleet operated, then retired in favour of AWS

< 1 h
to publish fresh news again on isolated infrastructure – DR exercised quarterly

$630K/yr
off the data center bill after the move to AWS – a quarter of the former cost

EXPERIENCE

Nuglif (La Presse)

Montréal, QC / 2016 – present

Manager, Cloud Infrastructure & Cybersecurity

June 2025 – present

Own the roadmap, budget and reliability of the platform.

- Took over the **GCP** environment: inventory, project structure, cost tracking, and a start on Terraform. Tightened permissions and limited access on the billing accounts.
- Put an internal analytics team's AWS account under governance: stopped manual production changes and fixed the security holes.
- Replaced permanent **IAM** users with SSO roles that have a limited session time, and changed the roles to cut down privileges.
- Deployed **Falco** in Kubernetes to detect threats at runtime, and tuned the macros to remove false positives.
- Set up a **CloudFront WAF** in front of the public frontend to limit AI bot traffic, keeping delivery cost in mind.
- Manage 5 people: four engineers and a database administrator.
- Build the yearly cloud and SaaS budget.

`AWS` `GCP` `Terraform` `IAM` `SSO` `CloudFront` `Cost engineering`

Systems Administrator (DevOps)

2016 – 2025

Ran about 1,200 VMs on VMware, set up and managed with Chef, then the early days of Kubernetes, then the move to AWS to deliver La Presse's daily editions.

- Proposed and led the move from self-managed Kubernetes to **EKS**, and replaced the **Weave** CNI where most of the instability came from: Kubernetes incidents went from about two a week to none.
- Set up the platform's disaster recovery plan: an **RTO under an hour** to publish fresh news again on isolated infrastructure, with no backup restored, and 12 hours for the main services. Tested the plan every quarter.
- Kept critical systems up to date, including the **Kubernetes** fleet. The **1.14 to 1.18** upgrade meant moving etcd2 to etcd3 and five to ten minutes with no API. It took preparation and a rehearsal before the change.
- Ran an alert review across the platform: fixed the recurring causes. Night calls dropped.

- Brought in **ArgoCD** and GitOps for the platform services.
- Took care of **Prometheus**, then helped move to Datadog.
- Replaced **Fluentd** with **Fluent Bit** for log shipping to **Splunk**: researched the tool, presented it to the team, and led the replacement.
- On the 24/7 rotation from the early Kubernetes days, through its first serious production incident.
- Split the **Terraform** code into modules by context.
- Cut the platform's blast radius: NetworkPolicies, security groups, least-privilege **RBAC** per service in Kubernetes and ArgoCD, and patching for published CVEs.
- Migrated the CDN from Cloudflare to **CloudFront**: a large recurring saving.

`Kubernetes` `EKS` `Terraform` `ArgoCD` `Helm` `Prometheus` `Datadog` `AWS` `Chef` `Python`

SKILLS

`Cloud`	AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM/IRSA, CloudFront, S3, EFS) · GCP
`Containers`	Kubernetes · Helm · ArgoCD · Cilium
`Infra as code`	Terraform · Chef
`Observability`	Fluent Bit · Splunk · Prometheus · Datadog
`Security`	IAM & SSO · least privilege · Kubernetes & ArgoCD RBAC · NetworkPolicies · Falco · CVE patching
`Reliability`	24/7 on-call · incident response · alert design · disaster recovery · capacity & cost · postmortems
`Code & systems`	Python · Bash · SQL · Linux (Debian, Ubuntu, Arch) · nginx · VMware · Active Directory

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate (SOA-C02) `2026 – 2029`

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) `2025`

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) – Linux Foundation `2021 – 2024`

Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS) – Linux Foundation `2022 – 2024`

EARLIER

DevOps – Asset Science LLC · Developer – Synchromedia, ÉTS `2014 – 2016`

EDUCATION

B.Eng., Information Technology Engineering – ÉTS, Université du Québec `2017`

B.Eng., Construction Engineering – ÉTS, Université du Québec `2011`

ALSO

`Languages`	French (native) · English (professional) · bassist in the band Dutch Nuggets since 2008